007-04 THE SINO-BRITISH NEGOTIATIONS AND THE JOINT (a.) DECLARATION 中英谈判与联合声明

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MacLehose’s successor 继任者, Edward Youde, arrived in Hong Kong in May 1982 during a period of great anxiety.

According to an opinion poll 民意调查 conducted 实施；进行 in May and June, the majority of Hong Kong’s population preferred (v.) the continuation of British rule, even though 即使，尽管，虽然 the British Nationality Act 国籍法 of 1981 had provoked a sense of betrayal.

The British government nevertheless 然而；尽管如此 saw *in Youde* someone 后定说明 who could work out 制定；达成 a suitable agreement with the PRC.

尽管如此，英国政府还是在尤德身上看到了(他可以作为)一个可以与中国达成合适协议的人。

A career diplomat 职业外交官 who had once been ambassador 大使 to Beijing and was fluent (a.)流利的；熟练的 in Mandarin 普通话, Youde had negotiated (v.) with the Chinese Communists in 1949 for the release of the HMS Amethyst (紫水晶)紫石英号事件.

Example 1. 案例

MacLehose’s successor, Edward Youde, arrived in Hong Kong in May 1982 during a period of great anxiety.
According to an opinion poll conducted in May and June, the majority of Hong Kong’s population preferred the continuation of British rule, even though the British Nationality Act of 1981 had provoked a sense of betrayal.
The British government nevertheless saw in Youde someone who could work out a suitable agreement with the PRC.
A career diplomat who had once been ambassador to Beijing and was fluent in Mandarin, Youde had negotiated with the Chinese Communists in 1949 for the release of the HMS Amethyst.

麦理浩的继任者尤德于 1982 年 5 月抵达香港，当时正值香港社会高度焦虑之际。根据 5 月和 6 月进行的民意调查，尽管 1981 年的《英国国籍法》引发了香港民众的背叛感，但大多数香港民众仍然倾向于继续英国统治。然而，英国政府认为尤德能够与中华人民共和国达成合适的协议。尤德

是一位资深外交官，曾任英国驻北京大使，精通普通话。1949 年，他曾与中国共产党就释放“紫水晶号”军舰一事进行谈判。

The Sino-British negotiations on Hong Kong’s future 谓 took two years.

The first round of negotiations, from October 1982 to June 1983, were conducted (v.) mainly **between** the British ambassador to China, Richard Evans, **and** the Chinese foreign ministry（政府的）部.

The chief bone 主要的骨头 of contention (看法，观点；争论，争吵)争论的焦点；争议的核心 was China’s demand (n.) that the British acknowledge (v.)承认；认可 Chinese sovereignty 主权 over Hong Kong, which Britain refused.

Only after Margaret Thatcher conceded 承认；让步 that /Hong Kong would revert 恢复；归还 to Chinese sovereignty 主权, on the condition that *the people of Hong Kong accept the reversion* 恢复；归还, did the negotiations **move on to** the second stage.

Example 2. 案例
我问: 中英香港谈判时, 英国难道一开始还想拒绝承认香港主权归中国么?

► Gemini:

英国在 1982 年确实试图通过“法律武器”来否认中国对整个香港的主权。

撒切尔夫人（Margaret Thatcher）在 1982 年刚打赢马岛战争，气势正盛。她当时试图坚持**“条约合法论”**：

- 三项条约：**英国认为《南京条约》（割让香港岛）、《北京条约》（割让九龙半岛）是永久性的；只有《展拓香港界址专条》（租借新界）才是在 1997 年到期。**
  英国的逻辑：“既然前两个条约是‘永久’的，主权就属于英国。我们现在只谈新界（占香港面积 92%）的租约，不谈香港岛和九龙的主权。”
- 以退为进：英国甚至提出过**“主权换治权”**——名义上可以给中国主权，但 1997 年后必须由英国继续管理。

为什么英国后来“松口”了？
文中所说的“Chief bone of contention”（核心争端）持续了近一年。英国最终承认主权，是基于非常现实的考量：

香港无法分割：新界提供了香港绝大部分的水、电和食物。如果 1997 年只交还新界，剩下的香港岛和九龙根本无法作为一个独立的城市生存。

我问: 中共说从未承认过那三个“不平等条约”，那么为什么《中俄尼布楚條約》中共就承认了?

► Gemini:

在学术界和外交界，《尼布楚条约》（1689年）通常被认为是一个“平等条约”，而真正被视为“不平等”的是后来清朝衰落时签署的《瑷珲条约》和《北京条约》。

《尼布楚条约》: 双方代表（索额图与戈洛文）是在对等尊严下进行谈判，并非一方强加于另一方。

《瑷珲条约》丢掉的外兴安岭: 俄罗斯是拥有核武器的大国。如果推翻所有历史上的不平等条约要求索回领土，意味着必须进行一场全面战争。

Another problem was that the two sides had very different views of what the final product 产品，制品;最终结果；最终方案 would look like.

As David Wilson, former political advisor 政治顾问 to the Hong Kong government (he had accompanied (v.)陪同；陪伴 MacLehose to Beijing in 1979) and member of *the British negotiating team*, recalled (v.)回忆；回想, "We had wanted to write a book — which **would have looked rather 颇，相当 like** the Encyclopaedia Britannica 大英百科全书 —while the Chinese wanted about two or three sides 边；面数 of A4 paper."

Example 3. 案例

The Sino-British negotiations on Hong Kong's future took two years.
The first round of negotiations, from October 1982 to June 1983, were conducted mainly between the British ambassador to China, Richard Evans, and the Chinese foreign ministry.
The chief bone of contention was China's demand that the British acknowledge Chinese sovereignty over Hong Kong, which Britain refused.
Only after Margaret Thatcher conceded that Hong Kong would revert to Chinese sovereignty, on the condition that the people of Hong Kong accept the reversion, did the negotiations move on to the second stage.
Another problem was that the two sides had very different views of what the final product would look like.
As David Wilson, former political advisor to the Hong Kong government (he had accompanied MacLehose to Bejing in 1979) and member of the British negotiating team, recalled, "We had wanted to write a book—which would have looked rather like the Encyclopaedia Britannica —while the Chinese wanted about two or three sides of A4 paper."

中英就香港未来进行的谈判持续了两年。第一轮谈判从 1982 年 10 月到 1983 年 6 月，主要由英国驻华大使理查德·埃文斯和中国外交部进行。双方的主要分歧在于中国要求英国承认中国对香港的主权，而英国拒绝了这一要求。直到玛格丽特·撒切尔同意香港回归中国，但前提是香港人民接受这一回归，谈判才进入第二阶段。另一个问题是，双方对最终结果的设想截然不同。正如香港特区政府前政治顾问、英国谈判团队成员戴维·威尔逊（他曾于 1979 年陪同麦理浩访问北京）回忆的那样："我们想写一本书——类似于《不列颠百科全书》——而中方只想写两三页 A4 纸。" 19

The second phase of negotiations began in July 1983.
The Chinese negotiating team was led by *Vice (a.)副的；代理的 Foreign Minister* Yao Gang, who was later replaced (v.) by *Assistant (a.) Foreign Minister* 副外交部长 Zhou Nan.
The British side was led by *former ambassador to China* Percy Cradock, although he was replaced by Ambassador Richard Evans in late 1983.

Governor Youde **participated in** the negotiations, but the Chinese insisted that /he be present (v.) only as a member of the British delegation 代表团；授权代表; the official PRC line（尤指为达到某种目的说的）话，言语 was that /the negotiations were solely between Britain and China, which represented the people of Hong Kong.

尤德总督参加了谈判，但中国坚持他只能作为英国代表团的一员出席；中华人民共和国的官方说法是，谈判只在英国和"代表香港人民的中国"之间进行。

Example 4. 案例
line

line

15. [C] (*informal*) a remark, especially when sb says it to achieve a particular purpose（尤指为达到某种目的说的）话，言语

- Don't give me that line about having to work late again.别再跟我说不得不工作到很晚这样的话。(*BrE*)
- That's the worst **chat-up line** I've ever heard.我听过的向人调情的话里没有比这更差劲的了。

Although public opinion in Hong Kong overwhelmingly 压倒性地；绝大多数地；强烈地 opposed (v.) a return to Chinese rule (a point 后定说明 that 主 Xu Jiatun, the PRC’s *de facto* 实际上；事实上的 representative (n.) in Hong Kong as director of the New China News Agency local branch, 谓 realized all too well), Deng Xiaoping believed otherwise.

尽管当时香港舆论压倒性反对回归中国统治（新华社香港分社社长、中国在港实际代表许家屯对此心知肚明），但邓小平却持相反看法。

In late 1983, Deng warned that /unless the negotiations were completed by October 1 (the PRC’s national day) in 1984, the Chinese would make a unilateral 单方面的；单边的；仅影响一方的 declaration.

Example 5. 案例

The second phase of negotiations began in July 1983.
The Chinese negotiating team was led by Vice Foreign Minister Yao Gang, who was later replaced by Assistant Foreign Minister Zhou Nan.
The British side was led by former ambassador to China Percy Cradock, although he was replaced by Ambassador Richard Evans in late 1983.
Governor Youde participated in the negotiations, but the Chinese insisted that he be present only as a member of the British delegation; the official PRC line was that the negotiations were solely between Britain and China, which represented the people of Hong Kong.
Although public opinion in Hong Kong overwhelmingly opposed a return to Chinese rule (a point that Xu Jiatun, the PRC’s de facto representative in Hong Kong as director of the New China News Agency local branch, realized all too well), Deng Xiaoping believed otherwise.
In late 1983, Deng warned that unless the negotiations were completed by October 1 (the PRC’s national day) in 1984, the Chinese would make a unilateral declaration.

第二阶段谈判于 1983 年 7 月开始。中方谈判团队由外交部副部长姚刚率领，后由外交部助理部长周楠接任。英方谈判团队由前驻华大使珀西·克拉多克（Percy Cradock）率领，但于 1983 年底由理查德·埃文斯（Richard Evans）大使接任。尤德总督参与了谈判，但中方坚持他只能作为英国代表团成员出席；中华人民共和国官方的说法是，谈判仅限于英国和中国之间，中国代表香港人民。尽管香港公众舆论普遍反对回归中国（这一点，时任新华社香港分社社长、中华人民共和国在香港的实际代表徐家屯深有体会），但邓小平却不这么认为。1983 年底，邓小平警告说，如果谈判不能在 1984 年 10 月 1 日（中华人民共和国国庆日）前完成，中国将单方面发表声明。

The main obstacle to the second phase of negotiations 系 was Britain’s hope to continue administering (v.) Hong Kong after 1997, even under Chinese sovereignty 主权；最高统治权；独立自主.

Cradock later claimed that /Deng Xiaoping was determined to recover Hong Kong fully, “even if it meant taking it back as a barren 贫瘠的；荒芜的；不毛的 rock.”

As it became clear that the Chinese were insistent (a.)坚持的；坚决要求的；固执的 on recovering Hong Kong, in late 1983 the British shifted (v.) their emphasis **to maintaining (v.) stability in Hong Kong** after the transfer 转移；移交；转让 to Chinese sovereignty, and in April 1984 /Foreign Secretary Geoffrey Howe regretfully 懊悔地，遗憾地 informed (v.)通知，告知 the Legislative Council that /it would be unrealistic 不切实际的；不现实的；空想的 to continue British rule after 1997.

Another obstacle arose (v.) when the Chinese suggested **appointing (v.) a joint commission** to manage (v.) the transition 过渡；转变；变革.

Convinced (v.)确信的；深信的；坚信不疑的 that this arrangement would fail, Governor Youde instead 代替，顶替，反而 suggested (v.) a Sino-British *Joint Liaison (n.)联络；联系 Group* that would be strictly consultative (a.)咨询的；协商的；顾问的.

(This Joint Liaison Group was established in Hong Kong /shortly after the end of the negotiations; the British side of the group was led by David Wilson, who would return to Hong Kong as governor in 1987.)

Example 6. 案例

The main obstacle to the second phase of negotiations was Britain’s hope to continue administering Hong Kong after 1997, even under Chinese sovereignty.
Cradock later claimed that Deng Xiaoping was determined to recover Hong Kong fully, “even if it meant taking it back as a barren rock.” 20 As it became clear that the Chinese were insistent on recovering Hong Kong, in late 1983 the British shifted their emphasis to maintaining stability in Hong Kong after the transfer to Chinese sovereignty, and in April 1984 Foreign Secretary Geoffrey Howe regretfully informed the Legislative Council that it would be unrealistic to continue British rule after 1997.
Another obstacle arose when the Chinese suggested appointing a joint commission to manage the transition.
Convinced that this arrangement would fail, Governor Youde instead suggested a Sino-British Joint Liaison Group that would be strictly consultative.
(This Joint Liaison Group was established in Hong Kong shortly after the end of the negotiations; the British side of the group was led by David Wilson, who would return to Hong Kong as governor in 1987.)

第二阶段谈判的主要障碍在于英国希望在 1997 年后，即便香港主权移交中国，仍继续管理香港。克拉多克后来声称，邓小平决心全面收复香港，“即便这意味着收回香港时，它仍是一片荒芜之地”。 20 随着中国坚持收复香港的立场日益明确，英国在 1983 年末将重点转向在香港主权移交中国后维护香港的稳定。1984 年 4 月，外交大臣豪威遗憾地告知立法会，1997 年后继续由英国统治是不现实的。另一个障碍是，中方提议设立一个联合委员会来管理过渡。尤德总督确信这一安排行不通，因此建议成立一个中英联合联络小组，该小组仅负责协商。（该联合联络小组在谈判结束后不久在香港成立；小组的英方负责人是戴维·威尔逊，他于 1987 年返回香港担任港督。）

Signed by Thatcher and Premier Zhao Ziyang on December 19, 1984, and ratified 批准；正式签署；使生效 on May 28, 1985, the Sino-British Joint Declaration **laid 放；铺设；安排 out** 布局 the main terms（协议、合同等的）条件，条款 of the agreement 后定说明 regarding Hong Kong’s future political status.

All of Hong Kong would revert (v.)恢复；归还；重归 to Chinese rule /on July 1, 1997.

Britain would administer (v.) Hong Kong until then /and would help maintain (v.) its economic prosperity and social stability; the PRC would cooperate (v.)合作，协作；配合，协助 in this process.

Hong Kong would become an SAR 特别行政区 with a high level of autonomy 自治；自主权；独立自主, except in defense and foreign affairs.
Hong Kong’s social and economic systems would remain unchanged, as would most of its current laws.

The Hong Kong government would retain (v.) control over trade policies and trading agreements.

香港政府, 将保留对"贸易政策"和"贸易协议"的控制权。

Hong Kong would remain a free port, with no taxes 后定说明 paid to China.
The rights and freedoms of speech, assembly, and religion would be preserved.

主 Troops of *the Chinese People’s Liberation Army* 后定说明 stationed (v.)驻扎，部署 in Hong Kong 谓 would not interfere (v.) in internal SAR affairs.

This one country, two systems arrangement —which Thatcher described as “an ingenious (a.)巧妙的；精巧的；有独创性的 idea” and Deng Xiaoping called “a product of dialectical (a.)辩证的；辩证法的；方言的 Marxism 辩证马克思主义 and historical materialism (唯物主义，唯物论；物质主义) 历史唯物主义”—would last (v.) for fifty years after 1997.

Example 7. 案例
ingenious

英 /ɪnˈdʒiːniəs/ 美 /ɪnˈdʒiːniəs/ 全球发音

简明 牛津 新牛津 韦氏 柯林斯 例句 百科

in·geni·ous *adj.* /ɪnˈdʒiːniəs/

1. (of an object, a plan, an idea, etc.物体、计划、思想等) very suitable for a particular purpose and resulting from clever new ideas精巧的；新颖独特的；巧妙的
   - an ingenious device精巧的装置
   - ingenious ways of saving energy节约能源的巧妙方法
2. (of a person人) having a lot of clever new ideas and good at inventing things心灵手巧的；机敏的；善于创造发明的
   - an ingenious cook心灵手巧的厨师
   - She's very ingenious when it comes to finding excuses.她很善于找借口。

DERIVATIVES 派生词

in·geni·ous·ly *adv*
- ingeniously designed设计巧妙

dialectical

英 / ˌdaɪəˈlektɪkl / 美 / ˌdaɪəˈlektɪkl / 全球发音

简明 新牛津 韦氏 柯林斯 例句 百科

adjective 派生词

英 /ˌdaɪəˈlektɪkəl/ 美 /ˌdaɪəˈlɛktək(ə)l/

▶ Adjective

1. relating to the logical discussion of ideas and opinions 逻辑论证的
   - dialectical ingenuity.逻辑辩证的独创性。
2. concerned with or acting through opposing forces 辩证的
   - a dialectical opposition between social convention and individual libertarianism.社会习俗和个人自由意志论之间的辩证对立。

materialism

英 /məˈtɪəriəlɪzəm / 美 /məˈtɪriəlɪzəm / 全球发音

简明 牛津 新牛津 韦氏 柯林斯 例句 百科

ma·teri·al·ism *n.* /məˈtɪəriəlɪzəm/

[U]

1. (usually *disapproving*) the belief that money, possessions and physical comforts are more important than spiritual values实利主义；物质主义
2. (philosophy 哲)the belief that only material things exist唯物主义；唯物论

——compare idealism(*2*)

Example 8. 案例

Signed by Thatcher and Premier Zhao Ziyang on December 19, 1984, and ratified on May 28, 1985, the Sino-British Joint Declaration laid out the main terms of the agreement regarding Hong Kong’s future political status.
All of Hong Kong would revert to Chinese rule on July 1, 1997.
Britain would administer Hong Kong until then and would help maintain its economic prosperity and social stability; the PRC would cooperate in this process.
Hong Kong would become an SAR with a high level of autonomy, except in defense and foreign affairs.
Hong Kong’s social and economic systems would remain unchanged, as would most of its current laws.
The Hong Kong government would retain control over trade policies and trading agreements.
Hong Kong would remain a free port, with no taxes paid to China.
The rights and freedoms of speech, assembly, and religion would be preserved.
Troops of the Chinese People’s Liberation Army stationed in Hong Kong would not interfere in internal SAR affairs.
This one country, two systems arrangement—which Thatcher described as “an ingenious idea” and Deng Xiaoping called “a product of dialectical Marxism and historical materialism”—would last for fifty years after 1997.

1984年12月19日，撒切尔夫人和赵紫阳总理签署了《中英联合声明》，该声明于1985年5月28日获得批准。声明阐述了有关香港未来政治地位的主要条款。香港将于1997年7月1日完全回归中国。在此之前，英国将管理香港，并协助维护其经济繁荣和社会稳定；中华人民共和国将在此过程中予以合作。香港将成为高度自治的特别行政区，但国防和外交事务除外。香港的社会和经济制度以及大部分现行法律将保持不变。香港特区政府将继续掌控贸易政策和贸易协定。香港将继续保持自由港地位，无需向中国缴纳任何税款。言论、集会和宗教自由等权利将得到保障。驻港的中国人

民解放军部队不得干涉香港特区内部事务。撒切尔称之为“一个巧妙的想法”，邓小平称之为“辩证马克思主义和历史唯物主义的产物”的这一“一国两制”安排，在1997年后持续了50年。

Local reactions to the Joint Declaration were mixed 复杂的.

Opinion polls showed that /most people preferred (v.) that *Hong Kong remain a British colony*, but most people had come to accept that *this was not a reality*.
Although some feared the prospect of living (v.) under Chinese rule, they were glad that /a deal had finally been struck.

While most Chinese leaders had pushed (v.) the British to try **to hold on to** 紧紧抓住或保持某物,不放手 Hong Kong, they quickly turned their attention to China /once the deal was finished.

Some 谓 took Chinese citizenship 公民资格，公民身份 and **gave up** their British awards 奖 and titles, but this was not always enough for Beijing.

一些人加入了中国国籍，并放弃了他们在英国获得的荣誉与头衔，但即便如此，对北京方面而言，这往往仍不足以表明立场。

In June 1984, Q.W.Lee, Lydia Dunn, and Sze-yuen Chung —all senior members of the Executive Council —were invited to visit Beijing.

The leader of the delegation 代表团, Chung, who had been knighted 封为爵士 twice by the British /and had originally argued for 论证,赞成；支持 continued British administration of Hong Kong, was chastised (v.)严厉批评；训斥；责罚 by Deng Xiaoping for questioning (v.)怀疑；对…提出异议 China’s ability to adhere to 遵守；坚持；遵循 the one country, two systems model.

代表团团长 Chung 曾两次获英国授勋，原本主张英国继续管治香港，因质疑中国能否践行“一国两制”方针而遭到邓小平批评。

Example 9. 案例
argue

argue

2. ~ (for/against sth) | ~ (for/against doing sth) to give reasons why you think that sth is right/wrong, true/not true, etc., especially to persuade people that you are right论证；说理；争辩

[V]

- They argued for the right to strike.他们据理力争罢工权利。

[VN]

- She argued the case for bringing back the death penalty.她为恢复死刑的主张提供论据。
- He was too tired to **argue the point** *(= discuss the matter)* .他太累了，不想讨论这个问题。
- a well-argued article凿凿有据的文章

[V that]

- He argued that they needed more time to finish the project.他提出理由说明他们需要更多的时间来完成该项目。

[VN that]

- **It could be argued that** laws are made by and for men.法律由人并为人制定的这一点颇有道理。

[alsoV wh-]

chastise

→ 来自chaste，使改正，使纯结。它来自拉丁语castus，与cast（投掷）有关，表示“清洁，与不洁之物及罪恶分开）。

英 /tʃæˈstaɪz/ 美 /tʃæˈstaɪz/ 全球发音

简明 牛津 新牛津 韦氏 柯林斯 例句

chas·tise v. /tʃæˈstaɪz/

[VN]

1. ~ sb (for sth/for doing sth) (*formal*) to criticize sb for doing sth wrong批评；指责；责备
   - He chastised the team for their lack of commitment.他指责队伍未竭尽全力。
2. (*old-fashioned*) to punish sb physically体罚

   SYN beat

DERIVATIVES 派生词

chas·tise·ment [U] /tʃæˈstaɪzmənt/ / tʃæstɪzmənt/ n

Example 10. 案例

Local reactions to the Joint Declaration were mixed.
Opinion polls showed that most people preferred that Hong Kong remain a British colony, but most people had come to accept that this was not a reality.
Although some feared the prospect of living under Chinese rule, they were glad that a deal had finally been struck.
While most Chinese leaders had pushed the British to try to hold on to Hong Kong, they quickly turned their attention to China once the deal was finished.
Some took Chinese citizenship and gave up their British awards and titles, but this was not always enough for Beijing.
In June 1984, Q.W.Lee, Lydia Dunn, and Sze-yuen Chung—all senior members of the Executive Council—were invited to visit Beijing.
The leader of the delegation, Chung, who had been knighted twice by the British and had originally argued for continued British administration of Hong Kong, was chastised by

Deng Xiaoping for questioning China’s ability to adhere to the one country, two systems model.

当地民众对《中英联合声明》的反应不一。民意调查显示，大多数人希望香港继续留在英国殖民地，但他们也逐渐接受了这并非现实的事实。尽管有些人担心生活在中国的统治下，但他们也为最终达成协议而感到高兴。虽然大多数中国领导人曾敦促英国努力保住香港，但协议达成后，他们迅速将注意力转向中国。一些人加入了中国国籍，放弃了英国的勋章和头衔，但这并不总是能满足北京的要求。1984年6月，行政会议高级成员李锟、邓丽君和钟思远应邀访问北京。代表团团长钟思远曾两次被英国授予爵位，他最初主张英国继续管辖香港，但邓小平批评他质疑中国能否坚持“一国两制”模式。

For the PRC government, the Joint Declaration was a way to prepare (v.) Hong Kong for reunification *as smoothly as possible* /and to assure (v.) Hong Kong people that their way of life would not change.

Still, many people in Hong Kong were frustrated (a.)懊恼的；沮丧的；失意的, and they resented (v.)怨恨；愤恨；对…感到愤慨 the way that the negotiations had been conducted, without *their having any say (n.)发言权，决定权 in the process*.

Example 11. 案例
without their having any say (n.)发言权，决定权 in the process

► DeepSeek:

without+ (their+ having+ any say)
介词 + (逻辑主语 + 动名词 + 宾语)

having 与 their 构成“主谓”关系，意为“他们的拥有”。

► Gemini:

这句话的结构，是典型的**“介词 + 动名词复合结构”**。

without (介词) → their (逻辑主语) → having (动名词)

- 因为在介词 without 后面，必须接名词性质的词，所以 have 变成了 having。
- 逻辑主语 (Logical Subject): 谁 having？是 they (香港人)。在动名词前面，我们通常用**所有格（their）或宾格（them）**来表示动作的发出者。
  在正式书面语（如历史文献）中，使用 their (所有格) 比用 them 更显专业。

双重否定感: without… any 强调了“一点都没有”，增强了那种被排斥的沮丧感。

又例:
- He left without my knowing it. (他趁我不知道的时候离开了。→ 动作发出者：我)
- I can’t imagine him winning the race. (我无法想象他赢了比赛。→ 动作发出者：他)

对比:

表达方式	句子示例	语气效果
普通句式	…and **they had no say** in the process.	陈述事实，语气平淡。
从句句式	…without that they had any say…	语法错误（**without 后面不能直接接 that 从句**）。
复合结构 (原文)	…without their having any say…	高级、紧凑，强调了“没有发言权”是这种沮丧状态的伴随条件。

These feelings were captured 体现；记录；捕捉 brilliantly 出色地；卓越地；才华横溢地 by Zunzi, a political cartoonist 漫画家 for *a leading local Chinese newspaper*, in a cartoon 后定说明 **depicting** (v.)描绘；刻画；描述 *Thatcher and Deng Xiaoping **as** parents* and *Hong Kong **as** a girl* 后定说明 about to marry (v.) a roll of paper 后定说明 held by *an anonymous 匿名的；不知姓名的, headless 无头的 man*.

The roll of paper represented (v.) the Joint Declaration, with the cartoon suggesting that 主 Hong Kong’s return to China 系 was like a traditional Chinese *arranged marriage* (n.) 包办婚姻 后定说明 in which the bride had no say.

This sense of frustration and resentment helps explain (v.) the blossoming 蓬勃发展；兴起；繁荣 of new political groups in the early 1980s, such as the Hong Kong Prospect 前景；展望；设想 Institute, the New Hong Kong Society, Meeting Point, the Hong Kong Forum 论坛, the Hong Kong Affairs Society, the Hong Kong People’s Association, the Association for Democracy and Justice, and the Hong Kong Policy Viewers.

Example 12. 案例

Header 1	Header 2
Institute：专业的“智库”或“研究中心”	核心内涵： 通常指为了特定目的（通常是学术、研究、教育）而设立的机构。 **侧重点： 专业性、研究性。** 文中例子： Hong Kong Prospect Institute（香港前景研究所）。这暗示该团体倾向于通过撰写报告、分析数据来影响政策，而非走上街头。 常见搭配： Research Institute (研究所), Art Institute (艺术学院)。
Society：志同道合者的“社群”或“学会”	核心内涵： 指一群为了共同兴趣、职业或目标而聚在一起的人，强调成员之间的联系。 侧重点： 稳定性、正式的会员制。 文中例子： New Hong Kong Society（新香港学会）。这类组织通常有章程、有固定的会员。 常见搭配： Royal Society (皇家学会), Law Society (律师会)。
Association：为了共同目的而结成的“协会”	核心内涵： 这是最通用的词，指人们为了某个特定的职业、商业或社会目的而联合。 侧重点： 利益代表、行业背景。 文中例子： Hong Kong People’s Association（香港人民协会）。**它通常比 Society 规模更大，更强调“对外代表”某个群体的利益。** 常见搭配： Football Association (足球协会), Student Association (学生会)。
Forum：公开讨论的“平台”或“论坛”	核心内涵： **原意是古罗马的广场，引申为交流想法、公开讨论的地方。** 侧重点： 开放性、对话性。

Header 1	Header 2
	文中例子： Hong Kong Forum（香港论坛）。这表明该组织的初衷是提供一个让不同政见者坐下来辩论、发表意见的场所。 常见搭配： Public Forum (公众论坛), World Economic Forum (世界经济论坛)。

When you see these words in a historical context, pay attention to their +"flavor": If you want to sound "smart" and "academic": Use **Institute**.
If you want to emphasize "talking to each other": Use **Forum**.
If you want to emphasize "we are a large group": Use **Association**.

总结:

词汇	翻译建议	核心性质	感觉/氛围
Institute	研究所 / 学院	侧重专业研究与学术输出	严谨、权威、像专家
Society	学会 / 社	侧重内部成员的共同价值观	正式、持久、像圈子
Forum	论坛	侧重公开讨论与观点碰撞	开放、互动、像广场
Association	协会 / 联合会	侧重群体利益与对外联络	通用、组织化、像工会

Although they represented a spectrum 光谱,范围；各层次；系列 of political opinions, these groups had several common traits 特征；特质；特性.

They were generally organized by former student activists who were now service (a.) professionals with strong links to the grassroots 基层民众；平民百姓；草根阶层 through their jobs.

Strongly committed 尽心尽力的，忠诚的 to nationalism 民族主义；国家主义；民族自豪感, democracy, and welfare capitalism 福利资本主义, these groups used (v.) legal channels 合法渠道 such as public seminars 研讨会, news conferences （大型、正式的）会议，研讨会, and position papers 立场文件 to broadcast (v.) their goals.

Example 13. 案例
seminar

→ 来自德语 Seminar,研讨会，讨论会，来自拉丁语 seminarium,育种室，来自 semen,种子，-arium, 表地方。

英 / ˈsemɪnɑː(r) /　美 / ˈsemɪnɑːr /　全球发音

简明　牛津　新牛津　韦氏　柯林斯　例句　百科

sem·inar *n.*　/ˈsemɪnɑː(r)/

1. a class at a university or college when a small group of students and a teacher discuss or study a particular topic（大学教师带领学生作专题讨论的）研讨课
   - Teaching is by lectures and seminars.教学形式为讲座和研讨课。
   - a graduate seminar研究生研讨班
   - a seminar room研讨室
2. a meeting for discussion or training研讨会；培训会
   - a one-day management seminar为期一天的管理研讨会

Example 14. 案例

For the PRC government, the Joint Declaration was a way to prepare Hong Kong for reunification as smoothly as possible and to assure Hong Kong people that their way of life would not change.
Still, many people in Hong Kong were frustrated, and they resented the way that the negotiations had been conducted, without their having any say in the process.
These feelings were captured brilliantly by Zunzi, a political cartoonist for a leading local Chinese newspaper, in a cartoon depicting Thatcher and Deng Xiaoping as parents and Hong Kong as a girl about to marry a roll of paper held by an anonymous, headless man. The roll of paper represented the Joint Declaration, with the cartoon suggesting that Hong Kong’s return to China was like a traditional Chinese arranged marriage in which the bride had no say.
This sense of frustration and resentment helps explain the blossoming of new political groups in the early 1980s, such as the Hong Kong Prospect Institute, the New Hong Kong Society, Meeting Point, the Hong Kong Forum, the Hong Kong Affairs Society, the Hong Kong People’s Association, the Association for Democracy and Justice, and the Hong Kong Policy Viewers.
Although they represented a spectrum of political opinions, these groups had several common traits.
They were generally organized by former student activists who were now service professionals with strong links to the grassroots through their jobs.
Strongly committed to nationalism, democracy, and welfare capitalism, these groups used legal channels such as public seminars, news conferences, and position papers to broadcast their goals.

对中国政府而言，《中港联合声明》旨在尽可能平稳地为香港回归做好准备，并向香港市民保证他们的生活方式不会改变。然而，许多香港市民感到沮丧，他们对谈判的方式感到不满，因为他们完全没有发言权。当地一家主流中文报纸的政治漫画家尊子（Zunzi）的一幅漫画巧妙地捕捉到了这种情绪。漫画中，撒切尔夫人和邓小平被描绘成父母，而香港则被比作即将嫁给一卷纸的女子，这卷纸由一个身份不明、没有头的男子拿着。这卷纸代表《中港联合声明》，漫画暗示香港回归中国就像一场传统的中国包办婚姻，新娘毫无发言权。这种挫败感和怨恨情绪有助于解释 20 世纪 80 年代初新兴政治团体的涌现，例如香港展望研究所、新香港协会、会合点、香港论坛、香港事务协会、香港人民协会、民主与正义协会以及香港政策观察员。尽管这些团体代表了不同的政治观点，但它们也具有一些共同特征。这些团体通常由曾经的学生运动人士组织，他们如今已成为服务行业的专业人士，并通过工作与基层保持着紧密的联系。这些团体坚定地拥护民族主义、民主和福利资本主义，并利用公开研讨会、新闻发布会和立场文件等合法渠道宣传其目标。

For the British, the Joint Declaration was an attempt to protect Hong Kong after 1997 /and to withdraw with dignity 尊严；庄重 and without appearing 显得，表现得 **as if** they

had surrendered 投降；放弃 Hong Kong and betrayed 背叛；出卖 its people.

(Cradock **called** the declaration “**as** comprehensive 综合的；全面的 protection **as** could be devised 设计；想出 and agreed.”)

Cradock 称该宣言是“这是当时所能构想和商定出的、最全面的保护。”

Example 15. 案例

“as...as could be”比较结构，用于表达“在某种条件下所能达到的极限程度”。

直译组合：“一种全面的保护，（其全面性）就（像）在当时能够构想出来并获得同意的（那种保护）一样（全面）。”

This helps explain (v.) why the British made minor 较小的；次要的 and belated (a.)迟来的；晚出现的 attempts to introduce (v.) democracy 民主 to Hong Kong during the Sino-British negotiations, **not only** to protect Hong Kong under Chinese rule **but also** to make *the transfer 转移；移交 to Chinese rule* more palatable (a.)合意的；可接受的 to the British Parliament.

Example 16. 案例

palatable

→ 来自 palate,腭，可口。

英 / ˈpælətəb(ə)l /　美 / ˈpælətəb(ə)l /　全球发音

简明　牛津　新牛津　韦氏　柯林斯　例句　百科

pal·at·able *adj.*　/ˈpælətəbl/

1. （of food or drink食物或饮料）having a pleasant or acceptable taste可口的；味美的

2. ~ (to sb) pleasant or acceptable to sb直人的；可意的；可接受的

• Some of the dialogue has been changed to make it more palatable to an American audience.有些对白有所修改以适应美国观众的口味。

OPP unpalatable

In July 1984 the Hong Kong government published a consultation 咨询；磋商 green paper 绿纸文件；政策意见书 on political reform, explaining its intention **to** “**develop (v.) progressively** 逐步地；渐进地 a system of government 后定说明 主` *the authority 权威；权力 for which* 系 is firmly rooted (v.) in Hong Kong, which is able **to represent (v.) authoritatively** 权威地；可信地 the views of the people of Hong Kong, and which is **more directly accountable 负有责任的；应负责的 to** the people of Hong Kong.”

在 1984 年 7 月，香港政府公布了一份咨询性的绿皮书 (这个文件是关于政治改革的)，解释了它的意图 (这个意图是) 去“逐步发展一个政制体系 (这个体系的权威是牢固地植根于香港的，并且是能够权威地代表香港人民观点的，并且是对香港人民更直接负责的)。” 这个改革计划包括了立法局的一个间接选举的部分。

Example 17. 案例

its intention to “develop progressively *a system of government* 后定说明 the authority for which is firmly rooted in Hong Kong, which is able to represent authoritatively the views of

the people of Hong Kong, and which is more directly accountable to the people of Hong Kong.

the authority for which..., which..., and which...
三个 which 引导的"定语从句"并列，共同修饰 a system of government

consultation green paper	咨询性绿皮书。**green paper是政府就某个议题发布的初步政策文件，旨在征求公众意见，尚未形成最终法案 (white paper白皮书)。这是民主决策过程的一部分。**
explaining its intention to	解释其意图 (去...)。explaining 是**现在分词作伴随状语，说明公布文件时的附带行为 (解释)。**
a system of government *the authority for which*...	一个其权力...的政制体系。the authority for which是较正式的表达，which指代 a system of government，for which是“对于这个体系而言”。
represent (v.) authoritatively the views	权威地代表...的意见。authoritatively指代表行为具有权威性和公信力，能真正反映民意。
is more directly accountable to	对...更直接地负责。accountable是“负有责任的、应作出解释的”，是民主问责制的核心。

在 1984 年 7 月，香港政府公布了一份咨询性的绿皮书 (green paper)，该文件是关于 (on) 政治改革的，解释 (explaining) 了它的意图，意图是“逐步发展 (develop progressively) 一个政制体系 (a system of government) (这个政制体系是) 其 (the authority) 权力 (for which) 牢牢植根于香港 (firmly rooted in Hong Kong) 的，(并且) 其 (which) 能够 (is able to) 权威地代表 (represent authoritatively) 香港人民的意见 (the views of the people of Hong Kong) 的，(并且) 其 (which) 对香港人民 (to the people of Hong Kong) 是更直接地负有责任的 (is more directly accountable)。”

The plans for reform included *an indirectly 间接地 elected part* of the Legislative Council.

Example 18. 案例
an indirectly elected part

一个间接选举的部分。指立法局的部分议员, 由"功能组别"或"选举委员会"等间接方式选出，而非由"全体选民直选"。

这份《代议政制绿皮书》是香港历史上首次正式提出"民主化改革"的官方文件，发生在《中英联合声明》草签前夕。其核心是在“港人治港”框架下，探讨如何在香港本地建立"有代表性的、负责任的"治理体系。**它试图在“主权移交”与“民主化”之间寻找平衡，**但“间接选举”的安排也反映了对“激进直选”的谨慎态度。

Although the government did not **commit 承诺；保证 to** direct elections, in November 1984 it published a *policy white paper* conceding 承认；让步 that “主 *the bulk 大部分；主体 of public response* from all sources 谓 suggested a cautious 谨慎的；小心的 approach /with a gradual 逐渐的；逐步的 start /by introducing a very small number of *directly elected members* in 1988 /and **building up to** 逐渐达到某个高潮或重要事件 a significant number of *directly elected members* by 1997.”

尽管政府并未承诺实行直选，但在1984年11月发布了一份政策白皮书，其中承认“来自各方的大部分公众意见, 都主张采取审慎态度，循序渐进——1988年先引入极少数直选议席，到1997年逐步增加至相当数量的直选议席”。

Example 19. 案例

For the British, the Joint Declaration was an attempt to protect Hong Kong after 1997 and to withdraw with dignity and without appearing as if they had surrendered Hong Kong and betrayed its people.
(Cradock called the declaration "as comprehensive protection as could be devised and agreed.")21 This helps explain why the British made minor and belated attempts to introduce democracy to Hong Kong during the Sino-British negotiations, not only to protect Hong Kong under Chinese rule but also to make the transfer to Chinese rule more palatable to the British Parliament.
In July 1984 the Hong Kong government published a consultation green paper on political reform, explaining its intention to "develop progressively a system of government the authority for which is firmly rooted in Hong Kong, which is able to represent authoritatively the views of the people of Hong Kong, and which is more directly accountable to the people of Hong Kong." The plans for reform included an indirectly elected part of the Legislative Council.
Although the government did not commit to direct elections, in November 1984 it published a policy white paper conceding that "the bulk of public response from all sources suggested a cautious approach with a gradual start by introducing a very small number of directly elected members in 1988 and building up to a significant number of directly elected members by 1997."

对英国而言，《中英联合声明》旨在保护 1997 年后的香港，并力求体面地撤离，避免给人以放弃香港、背叛香港人民的印象。（克拉多克称该声明是“当时所能制定和商定的最全面的保护措施”。）21 这有助于解释为何在中英谈判期间，英国迟迟才尝试在香港推行民主，其目的不仅在于保护香港在中国的统治下，也是为了让英国议会更容易接受香港移交中国。1984 年 7 月，香港特区政府发布了一份关于政治改革的咨询绿皮书，阐述了其“逐步建立一套权力牢牢扎根于香港、能够权威地代表香港人民意见、并对香港人民更加直接负责的政府体制”的意图。改革方案包括立法会中部分议员由选举产生。尽管政府没有承诺实行直接选举，但在 1984 年 11 月，政府发布了一份政策白皮书，承认“来自各方的大部分公众反馈表明，应采取谨慎的态度，逐步推进，从 1988 年引入极少数直接选举产生的议员，到 1997 年逐步增加直接选举产生的议员人数”。

The PRC **proceeded (v.) 继续做（或从事、进行） with** the Joint Declaration without complaint.

Example 20. 案例
proceed

词根词缀： pro-前 + -ceed-行走,退让

英 /prəˈsiːd/ 美 /proʊˈsiːd/ 全球发音

简明 牛津 新牛津 韦氏 柯林斯 例句 百科

pro·ceed v. /prəˈsiːd/

1. [V] ~ (with sth) to continue doing sth that has already been started; to continue being done继续做（或从事、进行）
   - We're not sure whether we still want to proceed with the sale.我们不确定是否还要继续减价促销。
   - Work is proceeding slowly.工作进展缓慢。
2. [V to inf] to do sth next, after having done sth else first接着做；继而做

   SYN go on
   - He outlined his plans and then proceeded to explain them in more detail.他简单介绍了他的计划，接着又进行了较详细的解释。

   (*humorous*)
   - Having said she wasn't hungry, she then proceeded to order a three-course meal.她先说不饿，接着却要了一份三道菜的大餐。
3. [V , + adv./prep.] (*formal*) to move or travel in a particular direction行进；前往
   - The marchers proceeded slowly along the street.游行者沿着街道缓缓行进。
   - Passengers for Rome should proceed to Gate 32 for boarding.前往罗马的旅客，请到32号登机口登机。

PHRASAL VERBS 短语动词

1. **PRO'CEED AGAINST SB**

   (law 律)to start a court case against sb起诉（某人）
2. **PRO'CEED FROM STH**

   (*formal*) to be caused by or be the result of sth由...引起；起因于；是...的结果

But in 1985 Xu Jiatun, the PRC’s representative 代表 in Hong Kong, **accused** (v.) the British **of** violating the Joint Declaration and trying to run Hong Kong after 1997.

As a compromise 妥协；折中方案, the British **agreed on** no major reforms until after the promulgation 颁布；公布 of the Basic Law in 1990.

Although in 1985 the Legislative Council was expanded by twenty-four elected members (and then to twenty-six in 1988), elected members still accounted for 占（比例） only 40 percent of the total membership.

None were directly elected; rather, half were selected by functional constituencies (选区) 功能组别；功能界别, while the other half **came from** twelve electoral colleges 选举团 whose members were from the lower councils.

Example 21. 案例

constituency

→ con-, 强调。-stit, 站，词源同stand, institute. 即站立其中的，构成其中一部分的。

英 /kənˈstɪtʃuənsi/ 美 /kənˈstɪtʃuənsi/ 全球发音

简明 牛津 新牛津 韦氏 柯林斯 例句

con·stitu·ency *n.* /kənˈstɪtʃuənsi/

(*pl.* **-ies**)
(especially *BrE*)

1. [C]a district that elects its own representative to parliament（选举议会议员的）选区
   - Unemployment is high in her constituency.她的选区的失业人数居高不下。
   - He owns a house in his Darlington constituency.他在自己的选区达灵顿拥有一座房子。
2. [C+sing./pl.v.]the people who live in and vote in a particular district选区的选民
   - constituency opinion选区选民的意见
3. [C+sing./pl.v.]a particular group of people in society who are likely to support a person, an idea or a product（统称）支持者

我问: 什么是 functional constituencies , electoral colleges, lower councils ?

► Gemini:

这段话描述的是 1980 年代香港民主化进程中的 **“间接选举”** 制度。
当时英国政府为了回应香港人“没有发言权”的沮丧，开始在立法局引入选举，但又不想一步到位实现“一人一票”，于是设计了这两个充满妥协色彩的机制。

Header 1	Header 2
Functional Constituencies (功能界别 / 功能组别)	这是香港选举制度中极具特色（也极具争议）的部分。 • 通俗理解： “按职业分摊名额”。 **在普通的选举中，我们是按"住址（选区）"投票；但在功能界别中，你是按"职业身份"投票。** 例如：医生选出"代表医生的议员"，律师选出"代表律师的议员"，商人选出"代表商界的议员"。 • 专业背景： **这种设计的初衷，是确保**香港作为一个国际商业中心，**其“精英阶层”（金融、法律、工程等专业人士）在议会中拥有稳定的发言权，防止政策过于偏向民粹。** • 文中语境： 1985 年，立法局首次引入 12 个功能界别席位，涵盖了商业、工业、金融、法律、医疗、教育等行业。
Electoral Colleges (选举团)	这个词在不同的国家有不同的含义（比如美国大选也有选举团），但在 1985 年的香港，它指的是一种 **“层级式选举”**。 • 通俗理解： **“议员选议员”（套娃式选举）。 香港当时有更基层的民意代表机构（比如：市政局、区域市政局，以及各区的区议会）。 这些基层议会的成员组，成一个“选举团”，由他们投票选出代表，进入最高层的立法局。** • 专业背景： 这是一种极度保守的**"间接选举"。普通市民选出"区议员"，"区议员"再选出"立法局议员"。**这样，立法局议员就与普通选民之间隔了一层“防火墙”，确保进入立法局的人是经过基层政治筛选的。 • 文中语境： 1985 年有 12 个席位，是由这种选举团产生的。

- Constituency: This comes from "constituent" (选民). In politics, it refers to *a group of voters* in a specified area /or *group* who elect a representative.

Example: The MP represents (v.) his constituency (选区/界别) well.

- Electoral College: "College" here doesn’t mean a school! It means *a body of persons with a common purpose*. An "Electoral College" is *a group of people tasked (v.) with choosing a candidate for a high office.*
  Example: The President of the US is technically chosen by *an Electoral College*.

正如你提供的原文所说，**即使有了这 24 个席位（12个功能界别 + 12个选举团），它们也全是“间接选举”产生的。**

这就解释了为什么香港人当时仍然感到“挫败”：因为**对于 90% 以上的普通市民来说，他们手里依然没有那张可以直接投向"立法局"的选票。**这种局面直到 1991 年才打破，那一年香港才开启了历史上第一次真正的“直接选举”（Direct Election）。

► DeepSeek:

Header 1	Header 2
Lower Councils (下层议会)	指代层级低于"立法局"（LegCo）的基层咨询或议会机构。 直译：下层议会 / 基层议会 具体包括： - District Boards / District Councils (区议会)：处理地区事务。 - Urban Council (市政局)：当时负责香港岛及九龙市区的文康市政事务。 - Regional Council (区域市政局)：负责新界地区的类似事务。 关系：这些“下层议会”的议员，构成了“选举团”的成员基础。即：市民选区议员 → "区议员"组成选举团 → "选举团"选"立法局"议员。

1985 年立法局选举路径图:

【1985 年新增 24 个民选议席（无直选）】

路径 A：功能界别选举（12席）
└─ 由各行业/专业界别内的选民直接选出
（如商界选民选商界议员）

路径 B：选举团选举（12席）
└─ 由“下层议会”的议员组成选举团选出
└─ 下层议会包括：区议会、市政局、区域市政局

这句话描述的是香港代议政制的起步阶段。所谓的“选举”并非一人一票的直选，而是通过“行业代表制”（功能界别）和“基层议员间接推选制”（选举团）来实现的。这解释了为何文中强调“None were directly elected”（无一直接选举）。

我问: 为什么当时的英国政府在 1985 年只肯给“功能界别”，而坚决不肯给“直接选举”吗？这背后是否也有中方的压力？

► Gemini:

Header 1	Header 2
中方施加的压力	• 中方担心英国在撤退前, 通过“直选”把香港变成一个独立的政治实体，或者扶植亲英势力上台。 • **警告英国：你在回归前搞的任何民主改革，如果跟未来的《基本法》衔接不上，1997 年之后统统都要废除。**
香港商界的恐惧：怕“分福利”	香港有权势的群体——商界精英和专业人士，也排斥直选。 • **怕加税： 商界认为，如果实行“一人一票”的直选，政客为了讨好选民，必然会承诺增加社会福利、提高企业税收。**

Header 1	Header 2
	• 功能界别的“避风港”：相比之下，功能界别 (Functional Constituencies) 是商界的最爱。它既能让商界在议会中有发言权，又不需要去讨好普通大众，能确保香港继续维持“低税率、重商主义”的环境。 英国政府当时需要维持香港经济稳定，因此必须安抚这些掌握财富的精英阶层。
对英国政府而言，1985 年的改革是一场“平衡艺术”：	• 英国必须给香港人一点“民主感”，以履行其作为宗主国的道义责任，并平息 80 年代初的“挫败感”。

On September 26, 1985, the first indirect elections were held for *twelve functional constituency seats* and *twelve district seats* for the Legislative Council (consisting of 由……组成 fifty-seven seats).

1985年9月26日，立法会（共设57个席位）首次举行间接选举，选举产生12个"功能界别席位"及12个"选区席位"。

Until then, the last significant 重要的；显著的 constitutional 宪法的；体制的 development had been in 1896, when two unofficial members were added to the Executive Council.

Although both the Legislative Council and the Executive Council had increased in size /and Chinese members had been added to each, the overall structure 整体结构 of the government had not changed, nor had the relationships *among the governor, the two councils, and the civil service*.

Example 22. 案例

The PRC proceeded with the Joint Declaration without complaint.
But in 1985 Xu Jiatun, the PRC’s representative in Hong Kong, accused the British of violating the Joint Declaration and trying to run Hong Kong after 1997.
As a compromise, the British agreed on no major reforms until after the promulgation of the Basic Law in 1990.
Although in 1985 the Legislative Council was expanded by twenty-four elected members (and then to twenty-six in 1988), elected members still accounted for only 40 percent of the total membership.
None were directly elected; rather, half were selected by functional constituencies, while the other half came from twelve electoral colleges whose members were from the lower councils.
On September 26, 1985, the first indirect elections were held for twelve functional constituency seats and twelve district seats for the Legislative Council (consisting of fifty-seven seats).
Until then, the last significant constitutional development had been in 1896, when two unofficial members were added to the Executive Council.
Although both the Legislative Council and the Executive Council had increased in size and Chinese members had been added to each, the overall structure of the government had not changed, nor had the relationships among the governor, the two councils, and the civil service.

中华人民共和国在未提出异议的情况下继续执行了《中英联合声明》。但1985年，中华人民共和国驻香港代表徐家屯指责英国违反《中英联合声明》，并试图在1997年后接管香港。作为妥协，英国同意在1990年《基本法》颁布之前不进行任何重大改革。尽管1985年立法会议员人数增加了24人（1988年增至26人），但民选议员仍仅占总议员人数的40%。所有议员均非直接选举产生；一半

由功能区选出，另一半则由12个选举团选出，这些选举团的成员来自下议院。1985年9月26日，立法会举行了首次间接选举，选举产生12个功能区议席和12个区议席（立法会共57个议席）。在此之前，上一次重要的宪政改革是在1896年，当时行政会议增加了两名非正式成员。尽管立法会议和行政会议的规模都有所扩大，并且都增加了华人成员，但政府的整体结构并未改变，总督、立法会议和行政会议以及公务员之间的关系也未发生变化。